A-A-50874A
30 May 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50874
25 May, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STOOL, STRAIGHT

Metal

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-S-37337 which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers a straight stool for use in patient care areas of hospitals.

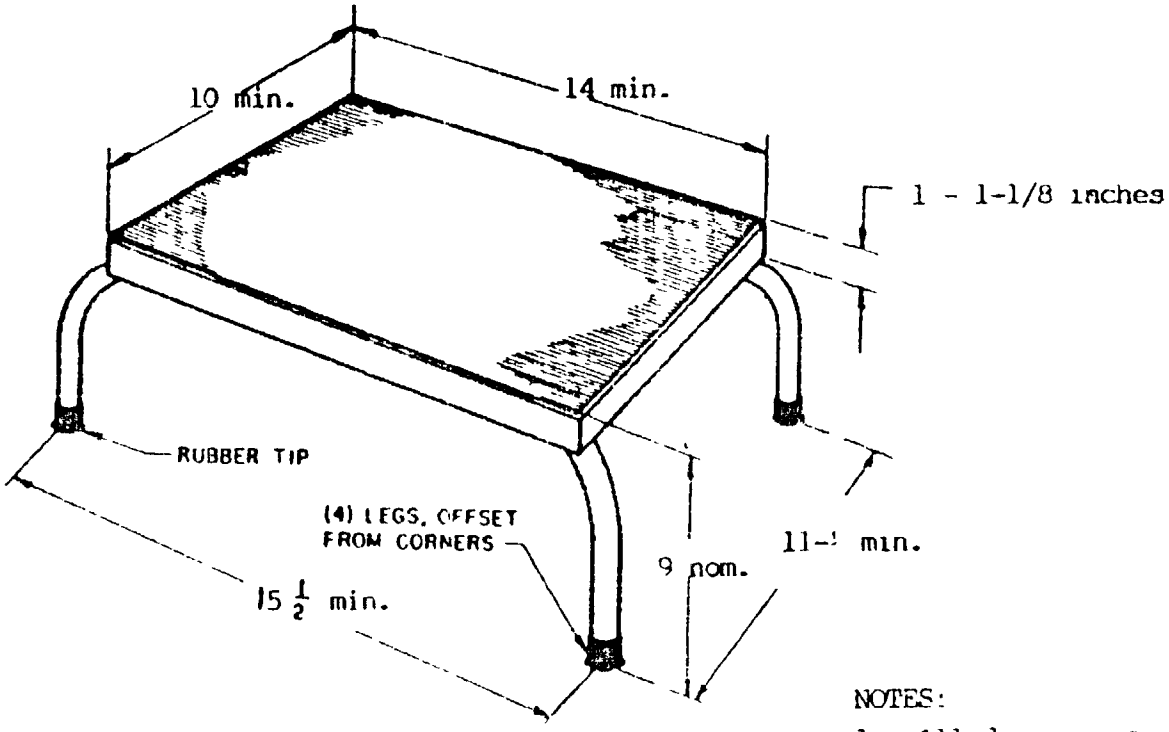
Salient characteristics:

The footstool shall be approximately 9 inches high, suitable for use in patient care areas of hospitals. It shall consist of a top with minimum dimensions of 10 inches by 14 inches covered with a ribbed, slip-resistant mat of rubber, or suitable plastic material, and four legs which shall be arched outward from the top to provide stability and to avoid tipping.

The material for the legs and top shall be steel or aluminum alloy. The subtop under the ribbed mat shall be formed from one piece of 18 gauge steel sheet. The contour shall include a flat area to receive non-skid material. The flat area shall be surrounded by a raised rib of a height equivalent to the ribbed non-skid mat. The perimeter of the subtop shall include a 1 to 1-1/8 inch vertical leg (see figure 1). As an alternate, the top may be fabricated from a suitable aluminum alloy having a strength comparable to that of the steel top. The legs shall be formed from chrome plated steel on polished aluminum alloy tubing, at least one inch in outside diameter and at least a 0.042 inch thick wall. The bottom of each leg shall be offset a minimum of 3/4 inch from the stool corner, in both the width and the length direction, in order to insure a stable stool. The end of each leg shall be closed off by plugging or capping, and shall be equipped with a snug fitting rubber tip. As as alternate to plugging or capping, a steel washer may be included in the bottom of the rubber tip.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTES:

1. All dimensions in inches.
2. Legs shall be offset a minimum of 3/4 inch in both directions to assure stability.

FIGURE 1. Stool.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The rubber or vinyl matting shall be securely cemented to the subtop and shall be ribbed, corrugated, or otherwise patterned to prevent slipping. Strength of the adhesive bond shall be 5 pounds or greater when tested in accordance with ASTM Standard Test Method D-903. The edge of the matting shall be protected in a suitable manner to prevent lifting from the stool.

All welds shall be sound, uncracked, and not porous. Any butt welds shall be ground smooth, clean, and free of slag or splatters. Final footstool finish shall be chrome-plated steel, or polished aluminum. Finish shall not show course grind marks, chips, or scratched areas.

Footstool shall not have cracks, tears, ruptures, or deformed surfaces. Exposed or accessible edges, corners, or surfaces, shall be free of burrs, sharpness, or sharp projections.

The finished footstool shall not rock in excess of one eighth of an inch when placed on a flat surface. It shall be capable of supporting a minimum load of 300 pounds.

Workmanship. The straight stool shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One stool, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 4.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one straight stool as specified in this description.

Defects.

Footstool is not chrome-plated steel or polished aluminum.

Legs are not arched to provide stability and to avoid tipping.

Leg ends are not plugged, capped, or fitted with a steel washer, as specified.

Rubber tips are not snug-fitting.

Edge of the matting is not protected in a suitable manner to prevent lifting from the stool.

Matting is not ribbed, corrugated, or otherwise patterned to prevent slipping.

Welds are unsound, cracked, or porous.

Welds are not clean, or not free of slag or splatters.

Footstool is not free from cracks, tears, ruptures, or deformed surfaces.

Exposed or accessible edges, corners, or surfaces are not free of burrs, sharpness, or sharp projections.

Finished footstool is not free from coarse grind marks, chips, or scratched areas.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional tests, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one straight stool.

a. First article. Where a first article sample is required, all tests shall be performed on that unit.

b. Acceptance testing. When a first article sample has not been required, one unit shall be subjected to the performance test specified herein. If a test article sample has successfully passed all tests, performance test shall not be required at acceptance.

Tests

Stability Test. The finished footstool shall be placed on a flat surface. Any rock in excess of 1/8 inch snall constitute a defect.

Load Test. The finished footstool shall be placed on a flat surface and a load of 300 pounds applied to the top surface. Any visible deflection shall constitute a defect.

Adhesive Strengtn Test. Testing of the strength of the adhesive bond between matting and subtop shall be in accordance with ASTM Standard Test Method D-903. A test result less than 5 pounds shall constitute a defect.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-00-299-8545

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 8030-2035

Location: CID/STOOL/H13-33

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-50874A	STOOL, STRAIGHT, Metal

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER (Specify):

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge (DO NOT STAPLE), and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4968 WASHINGTON D C
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTB
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:48Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.